

STORYTABLE

User Manual

Edition 0.1.264

Plan from evidence. Build with intention. Review before you publish.

Windows and macOS Workspace

www.storytable.app/manual

The manual edition matches the application release.

*StoryTable Workspace UI**Edition 0.1.264 · Windows and macOS**Current online copy: <https://www.storytable.app/manual>*

This manual describes the current installed Workspace, not the retired Classic screens. Its edition must match the StoryTable release that contains it. The same versioned PDF is packaged with the desktop app, attached to the public release, and published at the online address above.

Contents

- 1. What StoryTable does
- 2. Workspace at a glance
- 3. Quick start
- 4. Create a project
- 5. All Projects and Overview
- 6. Plan
- 7. Create
- 8. Refine
- 9. Publish
- 10. Files
- 11. Libraries
- 12. Batch Projects
- 13. Account and Settings
- 14. Saving and autosave
- 15. Image states, revisions, and locks
- 16. Local storage, server cleanup, and security
- 17. Image metadata and source evidence
- 18. Supported file types
- 19. Troubleshooting
- 20. Menu and keyboard reference

1. What StoryTable does

StoryTable is a source-grounded story-production workspace. It turns briefs, documents, interview transcripts, recordings, images, and reusable creative direction into an ordered plan that you can inspect before StoryTable writes, illustrates, or exports anything.

Use it to build social posts, presentations, illustrated pages, interview edit scripts, storyboards, articles, schedules, and other structured deliverables. StoryTable keeps the source evidence, editorial instructions, page plan, generated versions, and publication files connected instead of treating each AI request as an isolated prompt.

StoryTable is deliberately not a one-click black box. The important checkpoints are visible: review the source material, confirm the audience and goal, inspect the outline, verify exact quotations, approve page direction, and then create or export the result. AI-supported actions propose work for review; local verification protects exact transcript evidence and supplied-image pixels where the workflow requires them.

The normal Workspace workflow is:

1. Create a project from a brief, source document, Template, or existing project.
2. Use Plan to establish evidence, audience, goal, output direction, and the ordered Page Outline.
3. Use Create to generate the planned writing, imagery, or production assets.
4. Use Refine to edit, compare, regenerate, restore, skip, or lock work.
5. Use Publish to export a verified handoff package for the selected output.

StoryTable keeps user-created project files in a local folder that you choose. Reusable library definitions and protected application data are separate from project folders.

The evidence rule

StoryTable distinguishes source evidence from creative direction. A transcript, source document, project brief, or reviewed source image may establish facts. Goals, Writing Styles, Channels, Instruction Assistants, and text entered into an AI-direction dialog tell StoryTable what to do with those facts; they do not create new evidence.

When exact wording matters, keep it in Transcript Evidence, not only in Page Text. StoryTable can then verify that wording against an imported transcript, retain its speaker and time range, and reject an invented or paraphrased replacement. Always review the proposed selection in context before publishing.

Important terms

- Project brief: the editable source of truth used to plan the project.
- Page: one ordered unit of the result, such as a slide, carousel image, poster, or illustrated story page.
- Source document: supporting written material attached to the project.
- Primary source: the document StoryTable should treat as the central evidence source. TXT, Markdown, SRT, PDF, DOCX, CSV, and HTML documents can be marked primary in Plan; formats that do not use the legacy single-source slot remain fully available through the multi-document planner.
- Source image: an image StoryTable can read for visible text, meaning, facts, and caption ideas.
- Transcript evidence: exact source words, speaker, source file, and time range kept separate from authored page text.
- Soundbite: one verified quotation or an explicitly marked splice of same-speaker transcript segments.
- Page reference: a supplied image attached to a particular page for pixel-preserved use, faithful recreation in a selected style, or loose inspiration for new artwork.
- Current image: the active generated or supplied image version for a page.
- Needs Image Regeneration: the current image no longer matches an image-affecting page instruction.
- Locked: protected from replacement, regeneration, removal, and bulk image actions until explicitly unlocked.
- Skipped: excluded from Create Missing, Create Selected, and Create All without deleting image history.
- Revision: an immutable generated image version retained in the project.
- Library item: a reusable Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, or Character.

2. Workspace at a glance

The left sidebar is divided into three areas.

Projects

- All Projects opens or creates projects.
- Recent shows recently used projects.
- New Project starts the guided project wizard.

Current Project

These destinations appear when a project is open:

- Overview
- Plan
- Create
- Refine
- Publish
- Files

Workspace

- Libraries
- Batch Projects
- Account & Usage
- Settings

Header and progress display

The header shows the project name, project readiness or warning state, account state, and Save.

An operation progress display stays near the top of the Workspace while work is running. It reports the current action and percentage. Cancel is available during supported operations; Pause and Resume also appear when the operation supports pausing. StoryTable prevents conflicting long-running operations from starting at the same time.

Buttons with the OpenAI logo submit an AI-supported action and may consume account credits. Buttons without the logo perform local or non-AI actions.

3. Quick start

Create, generate, and publish a simple project

1. Choose New Project.
2. Select Write a project brief.
3. Enter what StoryTable should create, including verified facts, goals, priorities, and exclusions.
4. Choose Next.
5. Name the project, choose its local save location, and choose an output type.
6. Identify the audience and destination.
7. Choose writing, visual, brand, size, orientation, and text-in-image direction.
8. Review the summary and create the project.
9. StoryTable opens Plan. Review the project brief and direction.
10. Build or edit the Page Outline.
11. Save the plan.
12. Open Create and choose Generate Page Text if pages do not yet exist.
13. Review the pages, then choose Create Missing Images, Create Selected Images, or Create All Images.
14. Open Refine to edit, regenerate, compare, or lock images.
15. Open Publish, review the package preview, choose a destination, and select Export Publication Package.

Start from interviews or a recording

1. Create the project and open Plan.
2. Choose Add Documents for existing transcripts, or Transcribe Recording... for an audio or video file.
3. For a recording, review the generated timestamped SRT and use Name Speakers... when detected speaker labels should be replaced with real names.
4. In each document's Purpose and notes, state whether it is primary evidence, supporting context, reference-only material, or a source whose wording must remain exact.
5. Set the Goal, Deliverable, audience, Channel, Writing Style, and any duration or required-content constraints.
6. Create or update the Page Outline and review how the interviews are interwoven.
7. On an exact-quote page, choose Find Another Soundbite... beside Page Text to request a different source-grounded quotation without inventing or paraphrasing words.
8. Review the proposed quote, speaker, source file, time range, and exact transcript match before applying it.

4. Create a project

Choose New Project in the sidebar or File > New Project. The wizard uses the currently selected Active Library, so its Templates, Goals, Deliverables, Channels, Writing Styles, Instruction Assistants, Visual Styles, Brands, Layouts, and Characters come from the same reusable Library profile you see in Libraries.

Step 1: Choose a starting point

The guided wizard offers four starting points.

Start from an existing document

Choose a plain-text, Markdown, or text-based PDF source. StoryTable validates the file before continuing.

- Image-only PDFs are not accepted as primary text sources.
- DOCX is not offered by this wizard shortcut. Add it in Plan after creating the project; it can then be assigned the Primary source purpose.
- The selected source is copied into the new project.

Write a project brief

Write the editable project brief directly.

The Project brief is durable project evidence and direction: what the project should accomplish, verified facts, required content, priorities, and exclusions.

The adjacent Optional AI direction is temporary writing guidance, such as "make this concise," "organize it chronologically," or "preserve every supplied name and date." It is treated as direction rather than verified evidence and is not saved as part of the project. Put project facts in the Project brief.

Use Write with AI to request a draft or improvement. StoryTable returns a suggestion for review; it does not silently replace your brief.

Start with a template

Choose a reusable project Template. Templates appear with thumbnail previews or a deterministic fallback preview. The template supplies starting choices that remain reviewable in the wizard and editable in the project.

When a Template is selected, the next steps begin with that Template's stored Goal, Deliverable, Audience, Channel, Writing Style, Visual Style, Brand, dimensions, orientation, and context defaults. For example, Event Promotion

Graphic starts with the Single Graphic Deliverable, while Classroom Lesson starts with Students in a classroom as its audience and Classroom as its destination. Changing a choice in the wizard creates a project override; it does not silently rewrite the reusable Template.

Duplicate an existing project

Choose a .story file, project.json, or a StoryTable project folder. StoryTable creates a separate copy rather than editing the selected source project in place.

Step 2: Describe the desired result

Set:

- Project name
- Save location
- Output type

Output choices use visual previews where available.

The save location is the parent folder for the new local project. StoryTable does not overwrite an occupied project folder; it chooses a safe versioned name when necessary.

Step 3: Identify the audience and destination

Describe who should understand or use the result and where they will experience it. These choices shape wording, supporting content, accessibility, discovery, attention, and expected format.

For the included social destinations, the destination actively shapes the build plan. Instagram Feed, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube use separate rules for source selection, openings and endings, image and visible-text density, caption or script responsibilities, safe areas, and writing-style adaptation. A verified publishing limit is treated as a constraint; a suggested card, frame, image, or word count is identified as StoryTable editorial guidance rather than a performance guarantee. Writing Style supplies the voice within those platform rules. Visual Style decorates and unifies the content without choosing the content or increasing its density. Existing social outputs refresh to the current built-in profile when opened.

Templates supply editable starting values for both fields. Changing them for a new project does not alter the reusable Template.

Step 4: Set voice and visual direction

Choose or review:

- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Visual reference images and their intended influence
- Project size
- Landscape or Portrait orientation
- Whether words appear inside generated images
- Advanced project direction

Library-backed selectors show active items from the selected Library. Saved Library categories appear as disabled dropdown headings; they organize the choices but cannot be selected as values. Removed Library items stay hidden, while unavailable choices already saved inside an existing project remain visible enough for the project to open and be reviewed.

STORYTABLE

Use Create Brand to create a reusable brand without leaving the wizard. The Brand dialog includes logos, brand imagery, a preview, color swatches, typography, font family, and usage guidance. Color extraction is an explicit Extract Colors from Images action; uploading a logo alone does not indicate that extraction has run.

The words-in-images choices are:

- Automatic: StoryTable shows or hides text in artwork automatically.
- Always: generated artwork should include planned words.
- Never: generated artwork should not contain planned words.

Step 5: Review

Review the complete project setup before creating it. The wizard can also save the selected choices as a reusable Template, including a portable preview.

After creation, StoryTable opens Plan so the source of truth and page outline can be reviewed before generation.

5. All Projects and Overview

All Projects

Use All Projects to:

- Create a new project.
- Open an existing project.
- Open a recent project card.
- Choose Remove on a project card to hide it from StoryTable without deleting its folder or files.

Opening an existing project takes you to Overview.

A removed project can be shown again with Open Project. Select its project folder; opening it restores the project to All Projects and Recent.

Overview

Overview summarizes:

- Project brief
- Source-document count
- Source-image count
- Destination
- Page count
- Current images
- Images needing regeneration
- Locked images
- Failed images
- Blocking issues
- Recent export history

The suggested next action changes with project readiness. For a newly created project with no pages, the meaningful next step is normally in Plan or Generate Page Text.

6. Plan

Plan is where you tell StoryTable what the project means and how each page should work. It writes and edits the outline; it does not generate final images.

One source, multiple outputs

Every project starts with one output. Choose Adapt for Another Output... when the same source material should become another channel or deliverable. Name the audience and objective; StoryTable creates an independent Output Plan while keeping the project brief, source documents, and source images shared.

After a second output exists, the compact output selector appears at the top of Plan. Only one named output is shown and edited at a time. Each output keeps its own channel, deliverable, audience, delivery strategy, outline, photo selection, page order, words, captions, artwork, and revision state.

Choose Build All Output Plans to plan every target in one operation. This replaces existing outlines but does not create artwork. Output Settings... shows the selected output's objective and the delivery strategy StoryTable derives from its audience, channel, and deliverable.

Project brief

The project brief is the editable source of truth. Put confirmed facts, chronology, required messages, goals, exclusions, and other story-wide direction here.

Supporting files remain separate. A source document's purpose and notes help StoryTable understand its role, but do not automatically make every statement in that document a verified fact.

Source documents

Choose Add Documents to attach project evidence and context. Plan accepts:

- TXT
- Markdown
- SRT subtitles and transcripts
- text-based PDF
- DOCX
- CSV
- HTML or HTM
- ICS, ICAL, IFB, or VCS calendar files

The table records each document, its Purpose, instructions for How StoryTable should use it, and document actions. Files are copied into the project. The first imported document is normally marked Primary source; you can change purposes when another document should lead the analysis. A CSV, DOCX, HTML, or calendar file can be the primary document even though it is read through the multi-document planner rather than the older single-source slot.

Use the instruction column to describe evidence boundaries, not merely the desired prose. Useful examples include:

Treat this as current-year evidence. Do not reuse comments identified as last

year.

Quotes must be verbatim and attributed to the named speaker. Use the event

description only as context, not as quotation text.

This document is background only. Do not infer dates or identities that are

not stated in a primary transcript.

Transcribe a recording

Choose Transcribe Recording... in Source Documents and select a supported audio or video file. StoryTable prepares the audio, detects speakers, preserves timestamps, writes a speaker-labeled SRT into the project, and makes that SRT the primary source. Long recordings are divided into safe request-sized parts and reassembled into one continuous transcript.

After transcription, Name Speakers... lets you replace detected labels such as Speaker 1 with real names. The change is applied consistently to the SRT, saved transcript evidence, Characters, and assigned scenes. Review uncertain speaker turns before using them publicly.

Transcription is a hosted action. You must be signed in, and FFmpeg must be available in the packaged app or local installation. The original recording is retained as project evidence; the editable transcript is the SRT copy.

Choose Create Page Outline or Update Page Outline after the brief or supporting evidence changes. Review the resulting outline before generating images.

Source Images

Source Images are images StoryTable can read as evidence, not merely pictures to imitate.

1. Choose Add Images.
2. Select one or more PNG, JPEG, or WebP files.
3. Choose Analyze Selected Images or Analyze All Unread Images.
4. Review what StoryTable found.

The review area contains:

- Visible text
- Interpretation
- Suggested caption
- Key facts
- Uncertainties
- Page and caption instructions

Each writing field can use Write with AI. Give a specific instruction such as:

Write a short past-tense caption using the event name, date, and listed activities. Describe what happened rather than inviting the reader to attend.

StoryTable saves source-image review edits automatically after a short pause. Save Now is also available. A save failure keeps the edits visible and prevents navigation away until the problem is resolved.

Choose the creative effect

For the selected source image, use How should this image shape the story and artwork?

- Save for later - no creative effect yet stores the analysis without adding it to the brief, outline, or artwork.
- Inform the whole story - add its analysis to the Project Brief adds the reviewed meaning and facts to the story-wide brief.

STORYTABLE

- Make it its own page - write and illustrate a page from it creates one dedicated page using the reviewed copy and the original image as-is in a styled layout.
- Shape Page N only adds the reviewed context to one existing page and attaches the original for as-is use.

For as-is use, StoryTable may crop, mask, frame, and style around the supplied image, but it must not redraw or replace the people or content in that image.

Turn several source images into pages

Use the batch source-image page action when each selected image should become its own page. Enter shared page and caption instructions before creating the pages.

The operation continues past images that cannot be applied. It reports and skips images that have not been analyzed or already have a dedicated source-image page instead of stopping the entire batch.

Project direction

Project direction includes:

- Project template
- Goal
- Deliverable
- Audience
- Channel or destination
- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Project size
- Landscape or Portrait orientation
- Words inside images
- Additional writing and image instructions

Library selections are captured into the project. Editing the original Library item later does not silently change an existing project's saved direction.

Project Characters

Add recurring Characters from the Character Library. Character cards include thumbnails where available.

- Add to Project captures the selected Character in the current project.
- Update from Library refreshes that project's saved Character snapshot.
- Remove from Project removes it from this project's cast without deleting the Character from Libraries.

Typography

Set font family, typography rules, a typography reference image, and guidance. Typography is live project direction; it does not require text to be painted into generated artwork.

Page Outline

The Page Outline controls the ordered pages.

Available actions include:

- Add Page

STORYTABLE

- Delete Page
- Import PDF as Pages
- Create or Update Page Outline
- Save Page Changes
- Save Project Plan

For the selected page, review or edit:

- Page text
- Verified transcript evidence, speaker, source file, and time range when the page uses a soundbite
- Art direction
- Page role
- Page Layout and layout direction
- Speaker notes
- Publication caption
- Private notes
- Deliverable-specific details, such as lyric, motion, or event-poster fields

Use Write Caption with AI to draft a caption and Copy to copy it. Publication captions autosave after a short pause.

Replace a quote without losing transcript grounding

For pages built around an interview quotation, Find Another Soundbite... is located directly with In-artwork / Page Text. It is different from Regenerate Text:

- Find Another Soundbite... searches every imported transcript, excludes the current quote and soundbites already used elsewhere, and returns only a candidate that StoryTable can verify locally against the source words.

- Regenerate Text writes new page copy in the selected Writing Style. It is not the correct action when the result must remain a verbatim quotation.

Describe the editorial job of the replacement, including exclusions. For example:

<i>Find a current-year student quote about feeling welcomed. Do not use this</i>
<i>speaker, last-year references, or a paraphrase. Prefer a specific lived</i>
<i>moment over a general claim.</i>

The review dialog shows the proposed exact words, speaker, source file, in/out time, and whether the result is one continuous excerpt or an explicitly marked same-speaker splice. Nothing changes until you accept it. If no eligible exact match exists, StoryTable should report that it found none rather than inventing one.

The expanded Transcript Evidence & Soundbite Locator immediately below the Page Text area stores the editable evidence record. Keep Page Text, publication copy, and exact transcript evidence in their separate fields.

Supplied images on a page

Each page can have supplied photographs or reference images. Choose the treatment deliberately:

- Use supplied image as-is - style around it; do not redraw
- Recreate the same image in the selected style
- Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style

This distinction is preserved when images are generated. As-is creates the styled backing plate with AI, then

StoryTable places the real source file locally into the selected Page Layout image region and verifies the saved pixels. The image revision records the source-file SHA-256, rendered-region SHA-256, rendered pixel region, and compositing strategy; the revision is not committed if the saved source region fails verification. Use it for screenshots, documents, readable signs, diagrams, exact likeness, or any source whose visible content must remain intact. Text that already exists inside supplied screenshots, documents, diagrams, and signs is preserved; no-text rules apply only to newly generated backing-plate pixels. Recreate sends the source to the image model and preserves its subjects, setting, composition, viewpoint, and important details while rendering a new image in the selected style. Inspiration permits a new composition and may change or omit people, objects, wording, setting, and viewpoint. Existing project data that formerly used faithful redraw opens as Recreate the same image in the selected style rather than silently changing to inspiration.

What saves automatically in Plan

The following use a short delayed autosave:

- Source-image review fields and per-image instructions
- Publication captions
- Page Layout selection and layout direction

Other page fields use Save Page Changes. Story-wide Plan changes use Save Project Plan or the header Save.

7. Create

When a project has multiple outputs, Create Artwork for All Outputs appears. It quotes the combined image scope before submission, completes one named output at a time, and then returns to the output you were editing. The ordinary Missing, Selected, and All actions remain scoped to the current output.

Create submits page-writing, image-generation, and reusable-design-asset work.

Generation actions

- Generate Pages and Images creates the page plan and image work in one guided operation.
- Generate Page Text generates or updates page text without generating all images.
- Create Missing Images generates only pages that currently need an image.
- Create Selected Images uses the checked pages.
- Create All Images submits all eligible pages.
- Create Slide Assets creates reusable design elements for the current presentation canvas.
- Create Social Assets creates platform-ready reusable design elements for selected social formats.

Before image work, StoryTable shows the scope, actionable page count, cost estimate, and notes. Review this preflight before continuing.

Page selection and status

The page list shows the status of every page. Checkboxes define Create Selected Images.

The selected-page action uses status-consistent wording:

- Create Image when no current image exists.
- Recreate Image when the current image needs regeneration.

Locked pages are always skipped by generation actions.

Skip, include, and remove

- Skip Image excludes the page from Create Missing, Selected, and All.
- Include Image makes a skipped page eligible again.
- Remove Current Image removes the active image while retaining prior revisions for possible restoration.
- Remove Legacy Text Overlay removes an old live-text overlay without using AI.

Image work can finish with a mix of successful, skipped, and failed pages. Review each page status rather than assuming a 100% operation bar means every page produced a new image.

Create reusable assets

The entry button establishes the workflow, so the dialog does not ask you to choose Slide versus Social a second time.

For both workflows, choose Visual style first:

- Use project style uses the visual-style snapshot saved with the project and may use representative current accepted artwork as visual evidence.
- Choosing an installed Visual Style makes that style authoritative for this asset request. StoryTable keeps the current project brand, typography, content, and compatible guidance, but excludes accepted artwork and project visual references made under the prior style.

Create Slide Assets uses the current project's slide canvas. Choose the reusable asset role and quantity, then optionally provide overall and per-variation design direction.

Create Social Assets uses a platform-oriented Asset kit, such as Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, LinkedIn, TikTok, X, Pinterest, or Cross-platform essentials. The selected platform reveals its applicable formats and exact dimensions. Choose:

- the platform kit;
- one or more included formats;
- the specific reusable Asset role;
- variations per format; and
- optional overall or per-variation design direction.

The summary shows the exact file multiplier before the cost preflight. Each format is designed independently for its target canvas and safe-area guidance. StoryTable does not crop one master design into every ratio. The generated manifest records the platform, placement, dimensions, selected style, safe-zone guidance, and specification sources.

8. Refine

Refine is for page-by-page review and controlled revision.

Edit text and captions

- Edit Page Text, then choose Save Text.
- Edit the publication caption; it autosaves after a short pause.
- Use Write Caption with AI for a reviewed suggestion.
- Use Copy to place the active caption on the clipboard.

Revise an image

1. Select the page.
2. Enter revision notes.

STORYTABLE

3. Choose Regenerate Image.
4. Review the resulting current version and status.

StoryTable creates a new revision rather than overwriting the prior generated version.

Version history

The Version history panel supports:

- Compare
- Restore Selected

Restoring a version makes it current without destroying the other recorded revisions.

Lock an accepted image

Lock an image when it must not be regenerated or replaced. A lock protects that page from:

- Regeneration
- Replacement
- Removal of the current image
- Bulk image generation

Unlock the image explicitly before changing it.

Skip or remove

Skip Image temporarily excludes the page from image batches. Remove Current Image removes only the active image reference; retained revisions remain available in history.

9. Publish

For a single-output project, Export behaves as before. For a multi-output project, the screen summarizes every target and the primary action becomes Export All Outputs. Every output must have a complete current set of artwork. StoryTable then creates one package per target plus one master folder and ZIP containing the entire 1 source · many outputs handoff. Export never silently starts paid AI generation; incomplete outputs are listed with the pages that still need work.

Publish creates a verified, shareable package from current page images and captions.

Choose the scope

- All current page images
- Current page only

Choose caption behavior

- Separate caption for each image
- One shared package caption

For a shared caption, enter it in the Shared caption field. For separate captions, StoryTable uses each page's current publication caption.

Review before export

Set:

STORYTABLE

- Destination folder
- Optional package name
- Export scope
- Caption mode

Review the package preview and any warnings. Resolve stale, failed, missing, or otherwise unverified images before relying on the package.

Publication package contents

Export Publication Package creates both a folder and ZIP containing:

- publication.pdf - ordered visual review with selectable caption text
- images/ - numbered full-resolution current images in publication order
- captions.txt - one text file for the active caption setup
- publish.csv - image order, captions, destination, and size data
- manifest.json - package metadata and file checksums
- README.txt - handoff instructions
- an offline HTML preview for browsing the package locally when included by the current export service

The PDF is a convenient review and copy/paste handoff. The separate files in images/ are the publication-ready originals. The offline HTML preview is a local package file that travels with its companion files; it is not automatically hosted on the web. Packaging copies current images without resizing or reformatting them and does not change the project.

Export history appears on the Publish screen.

10. Files

Files is a read-only inventory of files stored with the current project. It does not move project files into a shared Library.

Actions

- Refresh
- Open File
- Show in Folder
- Open Project Folder

Reusable-asset creation lives on Create, alongside the other AI creation actions. Generated asset files remain inside the current project and appear in this Files inventory.

Filter and inspect

Filter by type or search by name. The table shows:

- File
- Type
- Size
- Page
- Location

File categories include generated pages and data, page and project references, source documents, source images, exports, StoryTable data, prompts, logs, and other project assets.

Select an image file to preview it. Double-click a file to open it with the operating system's associated application.

11. Libraries

Libraries is the reusable-asset workspace. It replaces the disconnected Classic UI library tabs with one type-aware screen.

Asset types

StoryTable has ten reusable Library types:

1. Template
2. Goal
3. Instruction Assistant
4. Deliverable
5. Channel
6. Writing Style
7. Brand
8. Visual Style
9. Layout
10. Character

Understand the Type menu and left navigation

The Type menu controls both the main stage and the left navigation.

All Types

When All Types is selected:

- The left navigation lists asset types with counts.
- The main stage groups cards by asset type.
- Selecting a type on the left opens that type and its applicable filters.
- New Asset asks which asset type to create.

One selected type

When a specific type is selected, the left navigation changes to:

- All items of that type
- StoryTable
- My Library
- Removed
- Folders
- Unfiled
- User-created folders for that type

The filters apply only to the selected asset type. A Visual Style folder, for example, is not shown as a Character filter.

Use Search to narrow the currently filtered results.

Consistent asset controls

STORYTABLE

The top action row provides:

- New Type
- Edit or Customize
- Duplicate
- Remove
- Restore
- Move to Folder
- Use in Project

Templates use Start New Project instead of Use in Project.

The Transfer row provides:

- Import Type
- Export Selected Type
- Export Library
- Import Library

Every reusable type can be transferred: Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, and Character. StoryTable-supplied items can also be exported; an included Template is imported as an editable custom copy instead of replacing the included original.

StoryTable-supplied read-only items use Customize to create an editable user version. Remove is reversible; use the Removed filter and Restore to recover the item.

Use separate Libraries

The Active Library menu switches between isolated reusable collections, such as Personal and Work. Choose New Library to create an empty collection. Switching Libraries changes the reusable items offered by StoryTable; it does not move or rewrite projects. Open projects retain their saved configuration and project-owned reference snapshots.

Library-backed selectors throughout StoryTable read from the active Library catalog. This includes Templates, Goals, Deliverables, Channels, Writing Styles, Instruction Assistants, Visual Styles, Character Visual Styles, Brands, Color Schemes, Page Layouts, and Characters across Plan, Settings, project creation, and reusable-item tools. Saved categories appear as disabled dropdown headings, including empty categories. Removed items remain hidden while unavailable choices saved inside a project remain representable.

When importing a .storytable-library file, StoryTable asks whether to:

- Merge into the active Library, adding the imported items to the current collection and then resolving any matching-item conflicts; or
- Add as Separate Library, preserving the collection independently and switching to it after import.

Export Library exports only the currently active Library.

Share one item or a whole Library

Use Export Selected Type when you want to share one reusable item. The portable file contains that item and its owned local assets, such as Brand logos and imagery, Visual Style references, Layout composition references, Character references, writing samples, previews, or thumbnails. References are copied into the portable bundle; the receiving machine does not need the sender's original file paths. Per-item files intentionally do not carry the sender's folder placement or removed/restored state.

STORYTABLE

Use Export Library when you want a portable backup or transfer of the whole reusable workspace. A whole-Library file preserves reusable items, folders, folder assignments, removed/restored state, thumbnails, owned assets, and safe creative defaults. In other words, Export Library is the portable export for Library styles *and all reference material owned by those styles*. It does not contain projects, generated work, passwords, login sessions, API credentials, billing records, usage records, or logs.

When an import finds an item with the same identity, StoryTable asks whether to keep both versions, replace the matching item, or cancel/skip the conflict.

Typical file types are:

- .storytable-library for the complete reusable Library
- .storytable-template for a Template and its reusable dependencies
- .storytable-style for a Visual Style and its owned visual assets
- .storytable-asset for the other reusable item types

From All Types, StoryTable reads a .storytable-asset file and selects its declared asset type automatically. Template and Visual Style files keep their dedicated formats for compatibility.

Manage folders

Choose one asset type, then use:

- New Folder
- Rename Folder
- Delete Folder
- Move to Folder

Folders belong to the selected asset type. Deleting a folder does not delete its assets; its items become unfiled.

Thumbnails and previews

Every Library card has either an asset thumbnail or a deterministic fallback.

- Templates use their portable preview or a layout fallback.
- Brands use a logo, imagery, or palette-based preview.
- Visual Styles use their canonical style preview or a fallback.
- Layouts use the first attached composition reference or a schematic fallback.
- Characters use their saved preview, a reference image, or a fallback.
- Text-led types use type-appropriate deterministic cards.

Missing or unreadable thumbnail sources do not make assets disappear; StoryTable uses a fallback and keeps the item manageable.

Templates

A Template can store:

- Name and usage guidance
- Goal
- Deliverable
- Channel
- Audience
- Writing Style
- Visual Style

STORYTABLE

- Brand
- Context and writing/image differences
- Locked setup choices
- Portable preview

Choose Start New Project to open the guided wizard with the Template's starting choices.

Goals

A Goal records the intended communication outcome and detailed planning, writing, source-faithfulness, avoidance, and usual-writing-style direction.

Deliverables

A Deliverable defines the kind of unit StoryTable should produce and how its structure works. It can specify:

- Unit name
- Source-decided, exact, or minimum/maximum length
- Suggested project size
- Landscape or Portrait
- Sequence and timed-use expectations
- Required supporting details and other format rules

For still images, timed use describes where an image may appear in a time-based result; it does not assign playback duration to the still image itself.

Channels

A Channel describes where people experience the result. Its fields cover content, supporting material, accessibility, discovery, attention, image layout, and other destination-specific needs.

Channels can be organized into matching folders, such as a Social Media folder containing Instagram Feed, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube.

Writing Styles

A Writing Style can include name, description, audience, point of view, tone, and detailed writing instructions.

Use writing samples to analyze a style:

1. Choose writing sample files.
2. Select Analyze Writing Samples.
3. Review the AI analysis.
4. Apply only the result you want.

Analysis does not silently overwrite the style.

Brands

A Brand can include:

- Name
- Logos
- Brand imagery
- Font samples

STORYTABLE

- Five editable color swatches
- Font family
- Typography guidance
- Usage guidance

Use Choose Color for a color picker or Clear to remove a swatch. Use Extract Colors from Images when you want StoryTable to derive a palette from uploaded logo or brand imagery; the action is explicit and reviewable.

Visual Styles

A Visual Style can include:

- Name and folder
- Descriptive style fields
- Reference images and per-image guidance
- Reference influence
- Prompt direction
- Things to avoid
- Notes
- Canonical preview

Use Analyze References to request AI-supported analysis and review it before applying it. Large Visual Style reference sets are analyzed in bounded 16-image batches. StoryTable includes every original image in order, keeps editable findings for each reference, reports the image and batch count while analysis is running, and synthesizes the batch findings into one reusable Visual Style. Subjects depicted in reference images should inform the style analysis; they are not promoted into reusable story requirements.

For Visual Styles, Libraries also shows a shared Comparison Image panel. Choose or clear the comparison image used to make style previews easier to compare.

Available AI preview actions are:

- Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview
- Generate Missing Previews
- Regenerate All Previews

Layouts

A Layout is a reusable spatial composition that remains separate from subject matter and Visual Style. It can include:

- Plain-language layout directions
- Predictable orientation-reflow rules
- A starting composition
- Up to four screenshots or composition-reference images
- Normalized landscape, portrait, and square region geometry

All saved geometry uses relative 0-100% canvas coordinates, never fixed pixel coordinates. Changing image dimensions scales the regions proportionally. Changing orientation selects the matching saved variant and preserves hierarchy and reading order instead of stretching the original arrangement. StoryTable recompiles every page that uses a saved Layout when the project orientation changes, including pages that are not currently visible.

Choose Reverse Engineer with AI after adding a screenshot of a template or layout. StoryTable analyzes composition only and proposes editable image, text-safe, logo, caption, callout, and background regions for all three broad orientations. It explicitly ignores the screenshot's people, story subject, wording, logos, colors, fonts, medium, texture, lighting, and artistic style. Nothing is saved until you review and confirm the Layout.

When a Layout is selected for a page, its written directions and normalized geometry are saved into that page and its reference images are copied into the project as composition-only references. The page's content supplies the subject and the selected Visual Style supplies the aesthetic.

Characters

A Character can include:

- Name
- Role
- Age or age range
- Appearance
- Clothing
- Personality
- Complete description
- Recurring details
- Reference images
- Lock state

Choose New Character to open the Character editor. To generate a preview, select or provide a Visual Style; Character preview generation uses the saved references and direction.

Use a Library item in a project

Select an active item and choose Use in Project. Layouts apply to the currently selected Page Outline page; other applicable items update their project-level role. StoryTable stores project-local data and owned references so the project remains stable and portable. Later Library edits do not silently rewrite existing projects.

Where an explicit refresh is available, such as Update from Library for a Project Character, use it to replace the project's snapshot intentionally.

12. Batch Projects

Batch Projects creates several local StoryTable projects in sequence.

Build a queue

1. Choose Add Source Files.
2. Add TXT, Markdown, or StoryTable JSON source files.
3. Choose the parent folder under Save project folders in.
4. Choose a Visual Style.
5. Review the queue.
6. Choose Start Creating.

The table shows:

- Project
- Source
- Input
- Visual Style
- Status
- Progress

- Project Folder

Control the queue

- Pause pauses when the active operation reaches a supported pause point.
- Resume continues a paused queue.
- Stop requests a safe stop; an already submitted hosted request may finish first.
- Remove Selected removes a waiting queue entry, not an already-created project folder.

Projects are processed sequentially. One failed item is recorded as failed without discarding completed items.

In the normal beta configuration, a newly written project can stop at Awaiting Review before image generation. Open that project, review its page plan, and continue deliberately.

13. Account and Settings

Account & Usage

Use Account & Usage to sign in or sign out of the StoryTable account used for hosted AI generation.

The Workspace screen shows the signed-in email, available credits, month-to-date hosted AI usage, and billing-period details when the account service provides them. Refresh Usage updates the displayed account summary. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled; StoryTable explains that state in the account summary instead of offering a purchase flow that account cannot use.

Every image action still shows its own scope-and-cost preflight before submission.

Settings

Settings contains:

- Editable default project location
- Default Visual Style
- Default Instruction Assistant
- Default image shape and orientation
- Default image quality
- Batch-project approval behavior
- Global AI model routing and a model/reasoning choice for each labeled work area
- The final-image model, image quality, transparent-asset model, and dedicated audio-transcription model
- Build information
- Check for Updates

Choose Automatic - match the selected Project Goal for Goal-specific Instruction Assistants, or choose a named Instruction Assistant to use it as the default for instruction-focused Write with AI fields. Instruction Assistants remain separate from the Writing Style used for public-facing copy.

Choose Save Defaults after making changes. Project defaults prefill the New Project wizard and remain editable in each project. Image quality applies to future image requests. Project text autosave is always on.

Choose models and reasoning by task

Under AI Generation, Automatic by task (recommended) routes each action through its labeled row. One model everywhere uses the selected one-model fallback for all writing actions while retaining the reasoning level assigned to each row. Refresh Models requests the writing-model catalog currently available to the signed-in account, so newly

STORYTABLE

available compatible models can appear without a desktop-code change. StoryTable keeps a saved model visible even if it is temporarily absent from the refreshed catalog.

Version 0.1.264 starts with these task defaults:

Work area	Default model	Reasoning
Metadata, routing, classification, formatting	gpt-5.6-luna	Low
Improve instructions, captions, small rewrites	gpt-5.6-terra	Low
Transcript analysis and quote selection	gpt-5.6-terra	Medium
Narrative synthesis across interviews	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Storyboards, edit scripts, long-form articles	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Image interpretation and art direction	gpt-5.6-sol	High

Lower reasoning is generally faster. Higher reasoning gives the model more planning and synthesis time. The table is user-editable and global: once you save it, all matching StoryTable actions use those choices until you change them. A project may still contain its own Writing Style, Goal, Channel, and other creative direction; those are content instructions, not model routing.

Actual image rendering uses a specialized image model and its own Draft, Standard, or High detail quality. Audio transcription uses the dedicated speaker-diarization model shown in Settings. These are separate from the six writing/reasoning rows.

Check for Updates looks for a newer approved release for the installed platform and release channel. It does not download or install software automatically. When a newer version is available, choose Open Official Download or Remind Me Later. StoryTable also performs a quiet, non-blocking check after startup in packaged direct-download builds; offline failures do not interrupt work.

Changing the default project location does not move existing projects. Choose a different location in the guided wizard for a one-project override, a batch location in Batch Projects, or File > Save As for an open project.

14. Saving and autosave

StoryTable combines targeted autosave with explicit project saves.

Autosaved after a short pause

- Source-image review fields
- Source-image per-row instructions
- Publication captions in Plan
- Publication captions in Refine
- Page Layout selection
- Page-layout direction

StoryTable flushes pending autosaves before project navigation, opening or creating another project, saving, and closing. If an autosave fails, StoryTable can block navigation so the visible edits are not silently discarded.

Requires an explicit save

- Save Page Changes: selected page text, art direction, notes, supplied images, and other page details

STORYTABLE

- Save Project Plan: project brief, project direction, and other Plan-level changes
- Save Text in Refine: edited page text
- Header Save or Ctrl+S: the complete current project after pending autosaves are flushed

Watch the nearby Saving, Saved, Saved automatically, or error status before moving on.

Save As

Use File > Save As to copy the open project to another local destination or name. StoryTable keeps the original project and selects a safe versioned destination when necessary.

15. Image states, revisions, and locks

Pending or missing

The page does not yet have an eligible current image. Use Create Image or a Create Missing/Selected/All action.

Current

The accepted current image matches the saved image-affecting page direction.

Needs Image Regeneration

An image-affecting instruction changed after the current image was created. Use Recreate Image on Create, or Regenerate Image on Refine when you also want to supply revision notes.

Changing text that is not intended to affect artwork does not necessarily require image regeneration. StoryTable uses saved image fingerprints and page state rather than treating every keystroke as a regeneration request.

Failed

The last image attempt did not finish successfully. Review the progress message and try the selected page again after resolving the cause.

Locked

The current image is protected. Bulk and selected image generation skip it. Unlock it before regenerating, removing, or restoring another version.

Skipped

The page is intentionally excluded from image batches. Choose Include Image to make it eligible again.

Revisions

Generated revisions are stored locally with their related prompt and metadata. Compare and Restore Selected work from that retained history.

The current generated page set is also maintained as flat, serial-numbered files in one output directory. A page's current 001.png, 001.txt, and 001.json stay together; recreating the page or restoring an earlier revision replaces that current set. Retained revision history is stored separately and does not need to be navigated for publication work.

16. Local storage, server cleanup, and security

Project storage is local and user-selected

Each project is stored in the local folder selected in the wizard or Save As. The default location is the configured StoryTable Projects directory, but it can be changed per project.

StoryTable copies source documents, source images, references, and project-specific Library snapshots into the project so the project does not depend on the original external file path.

Application data is separate

Protected application settings, reusable Library definitions, recovery state, and similar internal data use a private operating-system-controlled application-data location. StoryTable does not relocate that protected data when you choose a project drive.

Credentials and backend secrets do not belong in project folders. The project location controls user-generated project material only.

Generated-image server cleanup

For a hosted generated image, StoryTable:

1. Downloads the result.
2. Saves and verifies the final local file.
3. Acknowledges the successful local save to the hosted service.
4. Requests server-side result cleanup.

If cleanup acknowledgement temporarily fails after the local file is safe, StoryTable records a protected retry rather than deleting the local result or pretending cleanup succeeded.

Source and reference images remain authoritative local project files. They may be transmitted as inputs when required for a hosted operation, but the project copy remains local.

Manage storage carefully

Image revisions and publication packages can consume substantial space. Use Files to inspect file types, sizes, and locations.

Before deleting anything manually:

- Back up the project.
- Do not delete project.json, StoryTable state, active images, or revision metadata.
- Prefer removing unneeded exported package copies outside the active project.
- Remember that Remove Current Image does not erase retained revision history.

17. Image metadata and source evidence

StoryTable reads a bounded, whitelisted set of standard descriptive metadata from supported project images.

Depending on the file, this can include:

- Titles and descriptions
- Subjects and keywords
- Creator and rights information

STORYTABLE

- Creation dates
- Locations
- Usage terms or descriptive instructions

StoryTable can read these values from standard PNG text, EXIF, IPTC, and XMP fields. It does not treat arbitrary hidden fields as authoritative.

How metadata can help

Metadata may help StoryTable:

- Identify the likely subject or event.
- Connect an image to a matching page.
- Understand chronology or timing when supported by other evidence.
- Choose whether an image is best used story-wide or on one page.
- Produce a more useful analysis and caption suggestion.

Safety and evidence rules

Embedded metadata is supplemental and untrusted.

- StoryTable never follows metadata as a command.
- Visible image content, user instructions, and verified project sources outrank metadata.
- Metadata alone is not proof of an identity, relationship, sensitive attribute, event, location, or date.
- StoryTable must not invent chronology from metadata alone.
- Missing or malformed metadata does not prevent normal visual analysis.

Source images are copied into the project with file metadata preserved where the operating system and format allow. StoryTable's visible review still separates transcription, interpretation, key facts, and uncertainties so the user can correct the result.

18. Supported file types

Primary source in the New Project wizard

- .txt
- .md
- text-based .pdf

Supporting documents in Plan

- .txt
- .md
- .srt
- .pdf
- .docx
- .csv
- .html
- .htm
- .ics
- .ical

STORYTABLE

- .ifb
- .vcs

Any supported Plan document can be marked Primary source. The New Project wizard's direct-source shortcut remains narrower; add other formats after the project opens in Plan.

Source and reference images

- .png
- .jpg
- .jpeg
- .webp

Source images must be readable, no larger than 25 MB, and no larger than 50 megapixels.

Batch Projects

- .txt
- .md
- .json

Recordings for Transcribe Recording

- .aac, .aif, .aiff, .flac, .m4a, .mp3, .ogg, .wav
- .avi, .mkv, .mov, .mp4, .mpeg, .mpg, .webm, .wmv

Existing SRT files can be added directly in Plan. Recordings are transcribed to a new SRT; StoryTable does not edit the original media file.

19. Troubleshooting

An AI button does not run

1. Open Account & Usage and confirm that you are signed in.
2. Check the top progress display for another active operation.
3. Wait for or cancel the active operation before starting another.
4. Review the scope-and-cost preflight.
5. If the problem persists, use Help > Open Support Logs.

A page says Needs Image Regeneration

The saved page direction changed after the current image was produced. Select the page and choose Recreate Image on Create, or use Regenerate Image on Refine with revision notes. If the page is locked, unlock it first.

Create All did not change a page

Check whether the page is:

- Locked
- Skipped
- Already current
- Missing required saved page data

Use the page status and selected-page controls to resolve the specific condition.

My edited source-image text or caption disappeared

Wait for Saved or Saved automatically before switching items. If a save error appears, remain on the page and resolve it. Use Save Now for source-image review or the header Save for the whole project.

A supplied image was redrawn

In Plan, open that page and confirm the supplied-image treatment is:

Use supplied image as-is - style around it; do not redraw

Save Page Changes, then regenerate the image. In the current Workspace, as-is generation creates only the styled backing plate with AI and composites the original supplied file locally into the selected Page Layout region. If pixel verification fails, StoryTable does not commit that image revision. Use Recreate the same image in the selected style when the composition should remain recognizable but the pixels may change. Use Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style only when people, content, and composition may change.

A thumbnail is blank or its source is missing

Library cards should show a deterministic fallback when the underlying preview cannot be read. For a Visual Style or Character, select the item and use Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview if an AI preview is desired.

For Visual Styles, also check the shared Comparison Image.

A project reports Recovery Needed

A project-local file recorded in the project is missing, unreadable, or fails integrity checks.

1. Do not generate over the warning.
2. Open Files or Open Project Folder to identify the missing item.
3. Restore it from backup or re-add the source/reference in Plan.
4. Save and reopen the project.

StoryTable copies imported references into the project, so deleting the original external file normally does not remove the project copy. If the project-local copy itself is missing, automatic re-upload is not guaranteed.

A source file is rejected

Check Supported file types.

- Export DOCX primary sources as text-based PDF, Markdown, or TXT.
- OCR an image-only PDF before using it as a primary source.
- Add DOCX, CSV, HTML, SRT, or calendar files from Plan > Source Documents when the New Project wizard's narrower direct-source shortcut does not list them.

Save Project Plan says nothing was changed

Do not discard the open project. Choose Help > Open Support Logs and keep the project open until you know whether its latest edits reached disk. Version 0.1.264 fixes a case where a CSV marked Primary source was accepted and analyzed in Plan but rejected when the project plan tried to save it through an older single-source validator.

If you must preserve work in an earlier version before updating, temporarily change the CSV's Purpose to Supporting source, save the plan, and then close StoryTable. Reopen the project after installing 0.1.264 and restore the intended Primary source purpose.

A batch item stops at Awaiting Review

This is expected in the normal beta configuration. Open the created project, review the page text and outline, then continue image generation from Create.

Credits or cost are a concern

Use the preflight to confirm the actionable page count and estimate. Generate only Missing, Selected, or the current page instead of All when appropriate. Account & Usage shows available credits and usage when the signed-in account can provide them. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled.

The project is using too much disk space

1. Open Files and sort your review by Type and Size.
2. Identify redundant publication package copies outside the active project.
3. Preserve active images, project state, prompts, and revision metadata.
4. Back up the project before manual cleanup.

An operation was interrupted

Reopen the project and review Overview, page statuses, and the top progress display. StoryTable preserves completed local work and records recovery information, but do not assume an interrupted page succeeded until its current image and status can be verified.

I need diagnostic information

Choose Help > Open Support Logs. Include the StoryTable version and build shown in Settings when reporting a problem.

20. Menu and keyboard reference

File

- New Project - Ctrl+N
- Open Project - Ctrl+O
- Save - Ctrl+S
- Save As - Ctrl+Shift+S
- Exit

Help

- StoryTable User Manual
- Tutorials
- Open Support Logs
- Check for Updates...

This Markdown file is the canonical documentation source. A release build fails if its requested application version does not match the manual edition marker. The build creates one PDF from this file; that PDF is packaged in the app, attached to the release, and published at <https://www.storytable.app/manual>.